

FREE PROMPT PACK

London Through *Time*: the prompts

Every prompt I used to put myself into nearly 2,000 years of London history, from Boudica riding into Londinium to New Year 2026 over the Thames. Copy, paste, swap in your own details.

BY WOMEN LEAD AI · WOMENLEAD.AI

BEFORE YOU START

Show the moment, *not the backdrop*

This is part 2 of my Through Time series. For New York I walked through the city in each era. For London I changed one rule, and it made the whole video better: in every clip, the historic moment actually happens on camera. Boudica's chariot thunders past me. The crown is lowered onto William's head. Tower Bridge lifts for the first time.

I visit eight moments: AD 60, 1066, 1666, 1851, 1894, 1918, 1966 and 2026. I'm dressed for each era, an old paper calendar flips to every year, and each clip has its own sound.

WHAT YOU NEED

- **A Higgsfield account.** Each 8 second clip at 1080p cost me about 130 credits, and each character sheet about 3. The eight final clips came to just over 1,000 credits, plus a few redos.
- **2 or 3 clear photos of your face.** Front and three quarter, natural light, no heavy filters.
- **A list of real moments with real dates.** Check each one before you build a scene around it.
- **A video editor** such as CapCut, or Claude Code, to add the calendar and stitch the clips.

Each video clip took about 5 to 6 minutes to render. Start one, then write the next prompt while you wait.

THE FOUR STEPS

1. **Pick moments you can see:** events that happen in front of the camera.
2. **Dress for every era:** one character sheet per era, with your face.
3. **Animate the moment:** one 8 second clip per era, with sound.
4. **Flip the calendar:** add the years in your edit and stitch it all together.

Go to Higgsfield here: higgsfield.ai

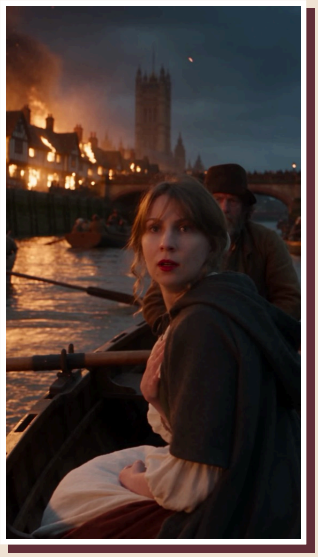
STEP 1

Pick moments *you can see*

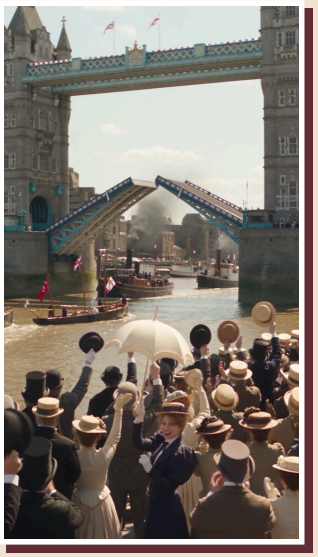
My first two clips were just me walking around a pretty Roman wharf and a snowy abbey. They looked nice and said nothing. A great moment has something that changes in front of the camera during the 8 seconds: a crown goes on, a bridge lifts, a ballot drops into a box.



1066: the crown goes on



1666: the city burns



1894: the bridge lifts



1918: the first vote

MY MOMENTS

AD 60	Boudica rides into Londinium (her revolt is dated AD 60 or 61)
1066	William is crowned at Westminster Abbey (25 December 1066)
1666	The Great Fire of London (2 to 6 September 1666)
1851	Queen Victoria opens the Great Exhibition in the Crystal Palace (1 May 1851)
1894	Tower Bridge opens and lifts for the first time (30 June 1894)
1918	Women vote for Parliament for the first time (14 December 1918)
1966	England win the World Cup, celebrations on Carnaby Street (30 July 1966)
2026	Midnight fireworks over the Thames as 2026 begins

> **Swap in your own city:** ask yourself what a person standing there would have watched happen. That's your clip.

STEP 2

Dress for *every era*

A character sheet locks your face and outfit so you look the same in every shot. Make one per era. In Higgsfield go to Images, pick **GPT Image 2.5**, quality high, resolution 2K, aspect ratio 16:9, and upload 3 photos of your face as references.

```
Character reference sheet of the woman in the reference photos, dressed as [WHO SHE IS, WHERE AND WHEN, e.g. a London merchant's wife in September 1666]. Keep her face EXACTLY as in the photos: [HAIR], [EYES], [LIPS], natural skin with real texture. Do not beautify, slim or change her face in any way.

Costume, historically accurate for [YEAR]: [PASTE YOUR OUTFIT LINE]. [HAIRSTYLE FOR THE ERA].

Layout on a plain warm light grey studio background: on the left a large close-up portrait facing camera; in the middle a full-length front view standing naturally; then a full-length side view and a full-length back view. Soft even studio light, photorealistic photography, natural proportions, real fabric texture and folds. No text, no labels, no logos, no watermark.
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Do this: keep the words "do not beautify", and check the sheet really looks like you before you spend credits on video. Everything after this depends on it.

STEP 2

My outfit lines, *ready to paste*

Drop one of these into the costume line of the prompt above.

ERA	OUTFIT LINE
AD 60	an ankle-length undyed wool tunica in warm oatmeal, a long draped palla in faded madder red wrapped over one shoulder, a simple bronze fibula brooch, leather sandals; hair centre parted, loosely braided and pinned at the nape
1066	an ankle-length wool gown in deep woad blue with wide sleeves over a long undyed linen undergown, a cream linen head veil wrapped loosely around the head and neck, a heavy dark brown wool mantle lined with grey fur fastened with a round silver brooch, soft dark leather shoes
1666	a fitted bottle-green wool bodice with a long pointed front and elbow-length sleeves, full white linen shift sleeves, a wide white linen falling collar, a full dark russet skirt, a plain linen apron, a dark grey hooded wool cloak; hair in a low bun with soft ringlets and a small linen coif
1851	a dusty rose and cream striped silk taffeta day dress with a fitted pointed bodice, a small white lace collar, white lace undersleeves and a full bell skirt over layered petticoats (no hoop yet); a cream straw poke bonnet tied with a wide pink ribbon; short white kid gloves; a paisley shawl
1894	a navy wool serge walking suit with huge leg-of-mutton sleeves, a white high-collared shirtwaist with a small dark ribbon tie, a smooth gored skirt to the ankle, black buttoned boots, a straw boater with a navy ribbon, white gloves, a cream parasol; hair in a soft pompadour
1918	a long belted deep plum wool overcoat with a dark brown fur collar, a high-necked cream blouse, a dark grey wool skirt above the ankle, black laced boots, brown leather gloves, a wide-brimmed dark felt hat, a small purple, white and green rosette on the lapel
1966	a sleeveless A-line mini dress in red, white and navy colour blocks with a white round collar, white knee-high go-go boots, a round white shoulder bag; hair in a half-up bouffant with a thick fringe and flicked-out ends, black winged liner, pale pink lip
2026	a long camel wool coat worn open, a chunky cream cable-knit jumper, straight-leg blue jeans, black leather ankle boots, an oatmeal wool scarf, small gold hoops; long loose hair

> **Tip:** give each era its own colour (red, blue, green, pink, navy, plum). Viewers clock the jump in time before they read the year.

STEP 3

Animate *the moment*

Go to Videos and pick **Seedance 2.5**. Settings: reference mode, **1080p**, **9:16**, **8 seconds**, audio on. References: the era's character sheet first, then two clear photos of your face. No start frame needed, the references do the work.

```
CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing exactly the costume from the character sheet: [SHORT OUTFIT LINE]. ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person (mixed ages, builds, hair), nobody dressed like her.

HISTORIC MOMENT: [DATE], [THE EVENT IN ONE LINE].

SETTING: [THE PLACE: architecture, objects, weather, light]. [THE CROWD AND WHAT THEY WEAR]. [WHO MAKES THE MOMENT HAPPEN, e.g. the archbishop, the bridge, the fireworks].

ACTION: [WHERE SHE STANDS]; [THE MOMENT HAPPENS IN FRONT OF HER]; [HER REACTION], then [A NATURAL SMILE OR LOOK TO CAMERA].

CAMERA: one continuous shot, [CAMERA MOVE], 9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on ARRI Alexa 65, anamorphic, real depth of field, real fabric physics, [LIGHT AND COLOUR MOOD], photoreal, indistinguishable from real footage.

AUDIO: [3 TO 5 SOUNDS FROM THE MOMENT], no music, no speech to camera.
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SOUND FOR EACH ERA

AD 60	thundering hooves, chariot wheels, carnyx horns, a roaring crowd
1066	monks chanting, a great shout of acclamation, bells
1666	roaring fire, collapsing timbers, alarm bells, oars on water
1851	an echoing crowd under glass, an organ and choir, a fountain
1894	steam whistles, a cannon salute, a brass band, cheering
1918	footsteps on a wooden floor, paper into a metal box, quiet claps
1966	crackly TV commentary, a huge cheer, a 60s beat band
2026	Big Ben chiming, fireworks over the water, a cheering crowd

STEP 3

My 1918 clip, *word for word*



CHARACTER: the woman from Reference Image 1 (character sheet) with the face from Reference Images 2 and 3, exactly this face, not beautified, wearing exactly the costume from the character sheet: long belted plum wool coat with a brown fur collar, purple white and green rosette on the lapel, cream high-necked blouse, wide dark felt hat, brown leather gloves. ONLY she has this face; every other person is a clearly different person (mixed ages, builds, hair), nobody dressed like her.

HISTORIC MOMENT: 14 December 1918, the first general election in which women in Britain can vote.

SETTING: a London polling station inside a school hall on a grey winter morning: wooden floor, tall windows with cold light, a Union flag on the wall, a trestle table with two elderly male clerks in dark suits and a ledger, a row of simple wooden voting booths with curtains, a black metal ballot box with a padlock and a slot on a table. Behind her a queue of women of all ages in 1918 coats and hats waiting their turn, among them a grey-haired older woman with a purple, white and green sash under her coat. All paper has no readable writing.

ACTION: she holds her folded ballot paper in her gloved hand, steps up to the ballot box, pauses for a breath, then pushes the paper through the slot; she straightens up and breaks into a proud, emotional smile, and the older woman in the queue behind her nods and smiles back; a few women in the queue clap quietly.

CAMERA: one continuous shot, starting close on her gloved hand and the ballot paper going into the slot, then a slow tilt and pull back to her face and the queue of women behind her, 9:16 vertical, never cuts. Shot on ARRI Alexa 35 with vintage lenses, real depth of field, real fabric physics, soft grey winter window light, slightly muted period colour, photoreal.

AUDIO: footsteps on a wooden floor, the paper sliding into the metal box, quiet murmurs, a few gentle claps, a clock ticking, no music, no speech to camera.

Why it works: the action has a beginning, a middle and an end inside 8 seconds (hand, ballot, smile), and the camera move follows it.

STEP 4

Flip *the calendar*

The calendar isn't made by the AI. AI video garbles numbers, so add the years yourself in the edit. That way every date is exact.

1. Open with a title for the first 2 to 3 seconds. Mine says "2,000 years of LONDON history, in one minute".
2. Make an old tear-off calendar page for each year: yellowed paper, a red strip at the top with the city name, the year in an old-style serif. Years before 1000 read "AD 60".
3. Over the start of each clip, flip quickly through the years in between, slow down, and land on the new year.
4. Once it lands, slide the name of the moment in underneath. Use a clear serif, not a fancy script: script is hard to read on a phone.
5. Put it on whichever side is clear of your face, and of the main action. That changes from clip to clip.
6. Add a soft paper flick sound to every page.
7. Stitch the clips in date order with short crossfades and keep each clip's own sound.



> **Shortcut:** I asked Claude Code to build the calendar flip as a transparent overlay video and to stitch the whole reel. If you use Claude, describe the look above and ask for "a transparent overlay video I can put on top of my clip".

LEARN FROM MY REDOS

Five fixes that *saved my clips*

1. **Show the event, not a stroll.** My first Roman and 1066 clips were me walking around. I remade them with Boudica's chariot and the crown going on, and they became the best clips.
2. **Watch for jumps.** In my coronation clip I was at the front, then suddenly further back in the crowd. I cut the clip just before the jump. Always watch to the last frame.
3. **Some props get blocked.** My champagne toast for New Year failed twice with no reason given. Sparklers worked first time. If a prompt keeps failing, swap the prop.
4. **History has its own rules.** 1066 Westminster had round arches, not pointed ones. Old St Paul's had no dome before the fire. Check every detail you can.
5. **One request at a time.** When I sent two clips at once, one sometimes failed. Wait for each to start before sending the next, and check your history before you retry so you don't pay twice.

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